

MIRROR PAGE

A comic-strip light-routing puzzle where an unreliable narrator twists the rules. • TGC Game Jam 2026 Proposal

Team / Creator	Sankeerth Nara (Solo)	Email	sankeerthnara@gmail.com
IndieConnect ID	[YOUR_INDIECONNECT_ID]	Public GitHub	github.com/SankeerthNara/TGC-Game-Jam (MIT)
Themes (All 3)	COMIC TWIST LIGHT	Target Playtime	12 – 15 mins first playthrough (20 min hard cap)
Engine & Renderer	Godot 4.7, GDScript only, GL Compatibility Renderer (Web/HTML5 export hosted on itch.io)		

1. PITCH & CORE CONCEPT

Somebody has sabotaged the lights of an old comic studio. You are a small caped comic hero with a torch in a **huge, pitch-dark station** of 20 rooms: only the area around you is lit. Explore, find the task consoles, and finish **15 interactive tasks** (rewire panels, fix fuse boxes, repeat lantern codes, align a telescope, wipe ink spills and more) to fill the **progress bar**. Some tasks are light puzzles on comic pages where you drag panels and flip mirrors to steer a beam. Who cut the lights, and why? The narrator has a few twists planned.

2. INTEGRATION OF THE THREE THEMES

Theme	How It Drives Gameplay & Narrative
Comic	The station is a comic-book studio (ink outlines, halftone paper, narrator captions, onomatopoeia) and the light puzzles are comic pages whose panels are movable tiles; gutters act as light refractors.
Light	The whole map is dark by design: only the area around your torch is visible, so light is how you explore. Light is also the puzzle: steering a beam off mirrors onto star targets.
Twist	The light sabotage is the story twist: the saboteur is among the characters and is revealed late. In the puzzle pages the narrator also twists the rules: the hero you light turns out to be the villain, mirrors lie, and gutters bend light 90°. (More twists are planned.)

3. CORE MECHANICS

- **Explore the dark:** Pokemon-style grid walking in one seamless 108x72 tile map. Only the area around the torch is lit. Press M for the station map.
- **15 interactive tasks, one progress bar:** wires, fuse box, lantern memory code, torch charge timing, telescope alignment, ink-spill reflex game, card swipe, and light-puzzle pages.
- **Light puzzle pages:** drag panels to swap them (their contents move too), click mirrors to flip them, steer the beam onto every goal. Unlimited undo.
- **Beam Tracing:** an instant headless raycast lights targets and flags hazards after every move.
- **Frictionless:** [Z] interact/undo, [R] reset, [M] map, Esc leave a task; no softlocks.

4. THE NARRATOR'S RULE TWISTS

Rule	Mechanical Impact	Introduced
Normal	Standard optical reflections: mirrors reflect as drawn; gutters maintain beam angle.	Levels 1, 2, 3
Goal Flip	Narrator caption flips polarity: good stars become toxic; hazards (red X) become the required target.	Levels 3 and 6
Lying Mirrors	Mirrors reflect the exact opposite of their drawn slant (slashes act as backslashes).	Level 4
Gutter Bend	Crossing a panel gutter forces a mandatory 90° clockwise beam deflection on the entry cell.	Levels 5 and 6

5. CONTENT PLAN & GAMEPLAY LOOP (15 MINUTES)

#	Level Name	Core Mechanic / Rule Introduced	Target Time
1	Page One (Library)	Panel swapping across gutters to carry a straight beam to the hero's star.	1.5 min
2	Looking Glass	Combining panel swapping with mirror angle toggles and wall obstacles.	2.5 min
3	The Twist	Goal Flip Twist: Solves normally, narrator flips roles, re-solve page for villain.	2.5 min
4	Liar, Liar	Lying Mirrors: Slashes reflect counter-intuitively; mental inversion puzzle.	2.5 min
5	Gutter Bend	Gutter Bend: Beams turn 90° at boundaries; locked panels limit swap freedom.	3.0 min
6	The Last Page	Grand Finale: Combines lying mirrors, gutter bends, locked tiles, and final flip.	3.0 min

Station loop: read the task list → walk through the dark to the next console → play its mini-game → progress bar fills → narrator reacts. 20 rooms, 15 tasks (4 are light puzzle pages), then the ending.

6. SCOPE BOUNDARIES

In Scope: huge dark station with torch lighting, 15 mini-game tasks with a progress bar, station map, 6 tuned light-puzzle pages, 3 rule mutations, goal flip twist, saboteur story twist, narrator caption UI, menus, end screen, comic sound effects, music, web export.
Out of Scope (Strictly Cut): Level editor, save slots, mobile touch, gamepads, multiplayer, more than 20 rooms.

7. TECHNICAL ARCHITECTURE & WEB FEASIBILITY

- **Engine & Renderer:** Godot 4.7 with GL Compatibility renderer; single-threaded Web export with zero native extensions or GDExtensions.
- **Model-View Decoupling:** pure GDScript puzzle model (PageModel, BeamSolver) separate from rendering; the station (World) and its 15 tasks are data-driven from a JSON map; each mini-game is its own class. Tested headless.
- **Automated Validation:** Built-in BFS/DFS solver (level_check.gd) verifies every level is 100% solvable within 2–8 optimal moves.
- **Web Export:** game package under 1 MB PCK (build about 38 MB uncompressed, ~8 MB gzip). 2D lights and darkness verified in a browser build.

8. 100-HOUR DEVELOPMENT MILESTONES

Hours	Phase & Deliverables	Current Status
0 – 12	Concept lock, core engine prototype, level format, art research, proposal submission.	COMPLETE
12 – 30	Vertical slice: dark station, tasks and progress bar, comic UI, first art pass, CC0 audio, pages 1–6 playable.	IN PROGRESS
30 – 60	Station polish, more tasks and room props, saboteur twist, sound and music integration, difficulty tuning from playtests.	Planned
60 – 85	Balancing, narrative comedic timing, web playtests, UI juice (panel shake, onomatopoeia).	Planned
85 – 100	Feature freeze at Hour 85. Web export audit, itch.io upload, README and CREDITS audit.	Planned

9. ASSETS & AI DISCLOSURE

- **Asset Rule Compliance:** Zero paid assets. All assets are 100% free, CC0, or open source with full attribution in CREDITS.md:
 - **Fonts:** **Bangers** (SIL OFL 1.1) and **Comic Neue** (SIL OFL 1.1) from Google Fonts.
 - **Audio:** Procedural CC0 synthesized sound effects and jazz loop generated in Python.
 - **Art & Textures:** Vintage newsprint textures, Ben-Day halftone dots, and comic burst badges generated procedurally.
- **AI Collaboration:** All AI usage is documented in docs/AI_USAGE.md across Claude Code (architecture/core logic), Antigravity (UI, art/audio assets, browser QA), and ChatGPT (tests/docs). Core creative direction and design decisions remain human-authored.

10. RISKS & MITIGATIONS

Identified Risk	Proactive Mitigation Strategy
Web Export / Browser Bugs	Tested every milestone via Playwright headless Chromium. Compatibility renderer enforced from Day 1.
Puzzles Unsolvable / Obscure	Automated headless level validator verifies solvability and move counts before authoring.
Scope Overrun	Strict 6-level cap, 15-minute loop target, hard feature freeze at Hour 85.